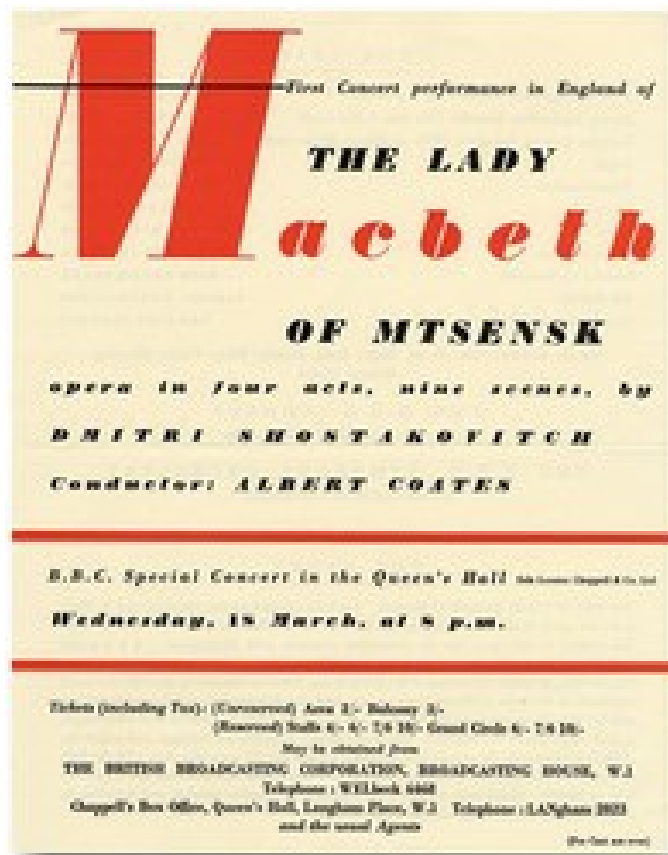


Nose is performed here in 2016 by London's Royal Opera, conducted by Ingo Metzmacher and directed by Barrie Kosky, at the Royal Opera House, Covent Garden.



LADY MACBETH OF MTSENSK

This is the program cover for the first concert performance in England of Shostakovich's opera. It was held at Queen's Hall, London, in March 1935.

The war years

At the beginning of World War II, he tried to enlist in the Soviet Army, but was refused because of his very poor eyesight. He remained in Leningrad as a firefighter, leaving only when the German attack on the city turned into a lengthy siege (see box).